

practical usefulness is questionable. Still, since it's in beta, we will need to wait to see how the functionality finally evolves. Winamp Remote, though, looks more promising. You will need to download an additional piece of



WinAmp—it really does whip the llama's a**! software to set up your own personal streaming server. That is, somewhat like the integrated ShoutCAST radio service where you can listen to streams from other users, Winamp Remote allows you to stream your media library to other computers.

As with other media players, adding songs and videos to your library is a snap. With hundreds and thousands of skins to choose from, you can customise the look and feel to reflect your style and individuality. Browse the Skins section at the Winamp site, and while you're at it, check out the Plugins section as well. There are tons of options to choose from and customise how Winamp behaves. Also check out the Predixis Music Magic mixer—it goes through your music library and mixes and matches acoustically similar music. Again, like with the audio fingerprinting in Windows Media Player, this is more at the experimental stage.

RealPlayer 10.5

<http://tinyurl.com/2unc6v>

RealPlayer needs no introduction. This music jukebox and media browser offers every feature that other media players / jukeboxes in the same class do. There are also the standard ripping and burning features, as well as support for Internet radio. It's for this last feature that you might want to adopt RP—there are tons of stations available. A serious drawback is that RP is a resource hog. Additionally, it loads some files at startup, which eat into your RAM space. The real annoyance, though, is that even if you manually delete the registry startup entry, RealPlayer will re-insert it every time you start the player!